

Site A, Instructor Interview 2

Interviewer: And just to touch based, so this is the last point of data collection just an interview that's focus on learning a little bit more about how things went and the lessons that you shared. And then some follow-up questions related to reviews of the videos that you shared. Do you have any questions before we jump in?

Site A Instructor: No, I mean, you know, the meaning of life. Why are people so stupid? Why, why are [STATE] politics determined to just strip academic freedom out of the hearts of the academy? Yeah not questions of the study.

Interviewer: Unfortunately, I don't have any answers for that. Okay, So, so thinking back to that, the lessons that focus on data analysis, what are your thoughts on how you feel like they went?

Site A Instructor: I think the students I think the students push themselves in useful and meaningful ways. I think that a number of them, a number of them wanted there to be like an explicit assignment that they did with the process. Like they wanted a product rather than just process. And I was not interested in a product. I feel like a lot of times that, that's often how people are trained to operate as researchers is to focus on the product and to skip the process. And so I tried a few times to explain that when they asked. I mean, because I have no issues when students ask, what are we gonna do with this or, you know, what is the end goal or whatever? I think those are reasonable questions its show that they're paying attention. Um, and so I mean, no one balked or rejected or a lot of them actually were like, Oh yeah. Um, but I am curious, one of the questions I'm asking them on their evaluation is specifically is about like, you know, like what would be the implications of having a product like would that have made the process more productive? Would it have stilted it like? Now having done this, you know, like what what would they have be different. And so I don't you know I don't know what their responses are going to be at. But I do I was I was personally okay with there not being like an assignment attached to the process. And I liked that they got to workshop their data with a lot of different kinds of people and a lot of different ways. And I think that I mentioned before we started recording their final, their final assignment, they read Norm's, *A qualitative manifesto: A call to arms*. And a number of them took issue with some of the things that not with like the ideas, more like the application of some of the ideas. And so for example, a number of them pointed out that like Norm talks about like you know this need to incorporate more people of color and they're like, yeah, except you don't cite any. Like you're preaching a gospel that you're not practicing kind of thing. And so, so they, they read the *Manifesto* and now they get to do their own manifesto. And so one of the things that in the past, they've always been able to do whatever they wanted. But in the past they've just defaulted to a paper. Because that's how they're socialized as academics, right? Like that's how we're taught, like, that's how we all, that's, that's how we end a class. We write a paper. And I think that this year, by virtue of having them like interrogate data analysis differently, they're doing this assignment differently. I don't think I have a single student who's just writing a paper. And I real, I think that a lot of that is product of, of them thinking more deliberately about the process of production um. And so a lot of them are really like, like they, they very actively reconceptualized um like the *Manifesto* is like you got something to say, what you got to say. And so, so like, one student is doing qual-fessionals, like instead of confessionals where she's asking them questions about like this pedagogy, refusal and different ways of reconceptualizing qualitative research and doing like little, like a little confessional sound booth um like a little podcast. Another person's doing a Spotify playlist.

And like his, rather than like a written texts, like the text is like his DJ script that he's in relation to. And I this, this is this group like the group is different because every, every group is different every, every class is different. But the class, like the group is not like different in that they came in more inclined to be creative in their, in their expression in their communication in their academics. And I, I really do think that having them explicitly interrogate the process of data analysis, the process of data production led to them more deliberately interrogating how do I want to, how do I want to say this because now like that they've had several weeks to re-, re-imagine like what research looks like. And so now it's like, okay, so now I'm writing a manifesto about research. I've already examined different ways that the research can look different. How might what I have to say look different. So anyway and so I don't have the final products yet. I don't know what they'll be, but based on I had individual conferences with each them and based on what they described, none of them are just writing a paper and for some of them like that's scary terrain. And so anyway, I don't like I I was like I lost her question and I meandering ran- response but I do feel like that's one of the effects that the data analysis had. But part of that was because I wanted them to really like rethink rethink data analysis of what it can be, what it should be, why it is that? Because the Tuck and Yang article that we read, the "Pedagogy of refusal: article that is, is a framework for the entire semester, one of the things they talk about is like how in software coding, coding is a very creative and very exciting process. Lots of elasticity, lots of imagination, lots of creativity. And then we, we take that concept and we plop it in to especially qualitative research because we're the coders with the inductive coders typically. And it becomes this very dry lockstep sort of thing. And, and and so anyway and so, so a lot of that was trying to figure out like, how do we, how do we not do that? And if we do that, if we choose to code in traditional ways, like being deliberate about why that makes sense. So

Interviewer: Is this the first semester that you taught that you framed this particular path with the pedagogy of refusal?

Site A Instructor: Yeah. Yes. So I got an [educational research] grant. I'm doing like a we're calling ourselves they call themselves that way they're calling themselves a qualitative survival group. They're all, they're all students who were getting the call PhD, who occupy various marginalized identities. And we, we, we adopted this pedagogy refusal as a way to examine qualitative methodology. And the more and we, like we read Bell Hooks and like, you know, *Teaching to transgress* and so on. And in thinking through that and talking with them about that I'm like this needs to be like this needs to be what I teach. Like this needs the way that I teach. And so this is I always taught one class a semester. And so this is the only class where it got applied. But I mean, I just, I think it's going to be a framework from here on out. I'm teaching case study and then social justice in qualitative research in the spring. And I mean, there that framework is going to be in full force to just because I think it's a useful way to, to have students interrogate the why and the how much more explicitly and deliberately, and have them do that work rather than me trying to do so much of that work for them.

Interviewer: Yeah, that makes sense. Was there anything that you found particularly challenging this semester or surprising when introducing the pedagogy of refusal as a frame?

Site A Instructor: I don't know that there's so for context um when I first came to [this state], our our undergraduate population is [predominantly white and upper socioeconomic status]. Like very [upper socioeconomic status] students, like over [half] are from out-of-state million

Interviewer: Really?

Site A Instructor: yes there's actually been [newspaper] articles about the [institution's] recruitment machine. They target very specific [upper socioeconomic status] pockets of the US. And they bring students here. And so this is a very [upper socioeconomic status] undergraduate population. And so when I taught undergraduates at [state], when I came here, it was kinda like a rinse and repeat sort of attitude. And so, and it was very similar. So for at [state], a lot of the doctoral students that are at [state] are also like they were undergraduate students at [state], double dogs triple dogs, you know, whatever. And so when I came here, I assumed that by virtue of this being the undergraduate population, that would be the doctoral population. And there is a really large group, like a really large population of um of international students and Black women who are in [Education] especially that's not the only students that we teach, we teach across the university. But I say all that to say that like relative to your question, these students, when I came um I taught women's studies at [state] and so it was always like a, basically trying to get them to understand like systemic oppression exists, like it really is real. And so I came with the assumption that that was kinda that was going to be kind of the way that I had ever. Qualitative research is like, you know, like research can be oppressive, research can be colonizing. Historically we have sucked and, and, and I didn't really have to do that work because a lot of the students were like, yeah. And so I think one of the reasons that the pedagogy of refusal, so it made a lot of sense with this group that is being funded through the grant. Because they're all marginalized anyway in a range of ways is like this resonated with them and they were the ones who selected as the framework. But the students that are in the classes, I'm trying to think through, um, I, I have, I have a couple of queer students. I have the majority of the class, the students of color, a number of them were Black women a number of them are mothers. And so anyway and so like and this is [Advanced Qualitative 3], right. And so like I've had a number of them in I think there's one student in the class that I had not taught previously. And so they didn't necessarily get a choice about taking [Advanced Qualitative 3] because they're getting the certificate, they're gonna get the PhD, they're going to take [Advanced Qualitative 3]. But they also like they knew what they were getting if they were registering to take it with me. Like it wasn't like, uh, I wonder if we will talk about critical perspectives in this class. It was like, you know, that's, that's, that's what you signed up for. But so to your question, in terms of difficulty, like they were all about it. And in a number of them have very explicitly integrated that concept into their manifestos. That was one of the ways that they vary directly engaged with Norm's work was like this refusal to accept that what he had to say was sufficient. And so there's a lot of like taking qualitative scholars to task in ways that I think were, were ultimately productive and empowering for them. I had this is it sounds like I'm, I'm bla- I'm, I'm I'm blathering, but, but I promise this is related. So a couple of years ago and [Advanced Qualitative 3], there was a group of, I think five Black women that were all higher ed PhD students. And I inherited the class and I just taught it as it was because I got it right before the semester started and I'm like, I don't know what the hell I'm doing anyway. So we'll just use this here syllabus and we will make the best of it. And damn, it was a bunch of dead white people. And I mean, the, the, this cisheteronormativity, the Eurocentrism, was just horrifying. It was embarrassing. And the students like me right away, like recognized this ain't it, it, you know, like there, there's a very critical lens to qualitative research here at [this institution]. And these students have basically been raised on like this being an understanding and expectation for qualitative methodologies. And then they get in [Advanced Qualitative 3] and they're just like what is this? I'm like you right like this sucks. And so actually that group of students and I wrote a paper like critiquing Eurocentrism in qualitative research relative to that class. And I started building in um uh so like they do these really short papers because I want to give them lots of feedback early on. And so, and so one of the papers that they do is they choose like once they have a notion of like what the class is about, what the class is trying to do, they choose a text on their own that they think should be integrated into the class. And then like the short paper is like why? And,

and so I think that's how I like. I'm almost sure that's how I initially read the pedagogy refusal. And um whoever the student is like, I do cite them each time I introduce it at the beginning of a semester. But all that to say that there wasn't any pushback or challenge. Now there are moments when the students like misunderstand each other. One guy he is, he's an older student, he's a former veteran, that's what his research is. And he says things sometimes that are unintentionally offensive. But the students, the students I think and I are able to mitigate that effect and to recognize that there isn't harm intended. And he's very receptive to being educated basically. But I mean, even he it wasn't like a resistance to this pedagogy of refusal, but the majority of them like relative your question, the majority of them like, I mean, that they, they really embraced it and it became a useful discussion point for a lot of what we were reading. Because a lot of what we read in the class, like they are refusals of norms like, you know, like Betty St. Pierre's rejection of data for example, and so on. And so it's like it when it became like this, almost like metaanalysis of where like they're reading people refusing norms but then they're refusing the refusal of the norms. You know but then like articulating why that is you know like articulating like why that's a problem. And so anyway, like I feel like I lost your question.

Interviewer: No, you didn't. You're spot on. So you started to hint at some of the questions that students have raised throughout the semester. Can you speak to like, were there particular questions that are common across the semester related to pedagogy or a refusal?

Site A Instructor: Yeah. So one of the questions that came up a lot, it wasn't explicitly about a pedagogy refusal. It was more of like a lot like so a number of the articles that they read over the course of the class are discussions of rejecting the norms of qualitative research. You know, critiquing the past of qualitative research, all which should happen. But then like part of this idea of refusal, like you're, you're like part of what that pedagogy supposed to do is encourage students to see, to see the structures that are, that are in place, that that are potentially pretending to do, so like Sara Ahmed, like this idea of, of having diversity versus doing diversity writes, like like the structures that pretend to do something for the purpose of having the ability to claim that you did the thing even though the thing didn't happen. And so a question that came up a lot over the course of the semester uh were were ones regarding like gatekeeping mechanisms in qualitative research. Because a lot of these people that are critiquing the norms in qualitative research have directly benefitted from them. And, you know, and so it's like you're writing about like we should do this differently or we should never do this or like we need to do this in a different way or whatever. But like you didn't you still haven't and if you did, you know, you're like this endowed chair at some, somewhere a university and so there's no risk for you. And so like a big question for them over and over again was like, What does this look like as a doc student? Right? Like what does this look like when I don't have the protection of tenure, when I don't have the protection of having an institution protect me. Because that's one of things that we definitely talked about in terms of like systemic inequities and systemic norms is like the institution doesn't exist to protect them. The institution exists to profit from them. Their labor is underpaid but essential to the operations of the university. And so they are in many respects exploited by this, by this structure. And so this structure does not exist to in any way, shape, or form insulate them. And so like what is it like? What is this work possible based on who I am is this work possible based on where I am? When I go on the job market and I do these things that you propose and I don't have the protections that you have what are the implications? What are the im- one of the concepts that came up a good bit and I don't remember came up in the recordings that I sent to you or not but one of the concepts that came up a good bit was this idea of legibility. Rightly this idea of like, how do I make myself legible in the field? Like to what degree can I color outside the lines? And it's still be legible. It's there'll be knowable

versus like me doing something so out-of-bounds that I'm no longer legible to my field. I'm no longer legible to my advisors. And so there's a lot of that discussion for sure. It's just like, you know, like what, what does this look like? And also this frustration of like, stop pretending that you're flipping tables over. When you're one of the ones you helped set the tables up. And there's also one of the other concerns they seem to have a lot of, was that a lot of these scholars have a lot to say about empirical research. And this came up a good bit over the course of semester. But a lot of these thoughts have a lot to say about empirical research and all the different problems empirical research and data analysis and coding and so on. And they're like but you don't even do empirical research. You know, you don't engage in that work and so it's really easy to critique something you don't participate in at all. And so, for a lot of them, it's like, you know, but I I do go jails, I do go to schools, I do go to counseling centers, I do go, and so, and, and that's important that my research do that like it's important my research interact with these people. You know but you're telling me don't do these things, but then you don't do any of that. And so, and so those were some of the big things just this pedagogy of refusal concept was like very much this idea of like looking at the structures um and also recognizing the ways of the structures we remake themselves. Because you're like, well that's you like Butler, Judith Butler's like frames of war concept like the idea that like inequity and oppression don't stay static, like they're dynamic concepts, right? And so they're constantly shifting and remaking themselves. And so like racism in the 1950s isn't what racism looks like now. If it's racism from the 1950s, typically we can look at and be like, Oh, that's racism. But because it's a dynamic concept and it shifted and adapted, it's more insidious and it's more invisible and so like. So that was one of the big parts is like looking at like the invisible structures and the ways that they are working to dictate but then also the other part of that was like recognizing the degrees to which their, their advisors or chairs, whatever are also instituting norms, instituting structural expectations that are oppressive, that are problematic. And so like one of the students she wants to do scholarship on, a counselor, counselor ed PhD student, and she wants to do scholarship on like people who lived through the civil rights era and the trauma of racialized experiences. And she keeps getting told by a program like that's not as marketable as if you did this. You know, like where are you going to publish this? And so that's like that's constantly something to that they think they would come back to this idea of gatekeeping, again, it's like a lot of times like that's the control mechanism to is, well, if you do this, then you're not going to get published. If you do this, you're not going to be employable. And so recognizing that sometimes those moments are not actually about, and it's not like the advisors were being like mean or insidious, but it's more of like recognizing that sometimes those uh those concerns are actually more voicing structural norms than they are actual risk. And so anyway, and so I'll stop there.

Interviewer: Yeah that's so powerful. We noticed in the lessons that you shared that you often had students doing, I think you just called a collaborative data sharing?

Site A Instructor: Yes. I don't ((unhearable))

Interviewer: Can you talk a little bit? I understand. And don't I remember last week very well, myself or yesterday. So can you talk a little bit about that, that approach that you took and what you're thinking that's around it.

Site A Instructor: Yeah. Yeah. So I do a lot of of of peer review and collaborative review, I uh in all my classes and everything in the class, there's some element of a peer review, peer collaboration, peer feedback. Because they make each other better. They make each other smarter, they make me smarter. And and the other thing is like, I'd like one of the things that I definitely I've been adamant about for a long time, I feel like there's a lot of like

competitiveness, and, and there's, there's this, this very dark aspect to academia where you're always set up to see other people as, as an obstacle or as someone who is so if this person, it's like the idea of like equity, right like it's not like pie, we can all get a piece and we're still not going to be out of pie. But it's like there's, there's an aspect of doctoral education that feels like that sometimes where it's like, I can't be happy for this person for getting a publication because I don't have one yet. I can't be happy for this person for being a part of a grant because I haven't done that yet. And I don't think faculty help because we're constantly, they would publish and perish agenda of our blah, blah, blah. And, and so I, I know that I am smarter and I am better when I think with people. When I think because of people. I haven't ever had a single manuscript that I sent to a journal that didn't get better because of peer review. I haven't ever had a single I haven't ever had a single teaching semester that hasn't gotten better because of students' feedback. That doesn't mean that I agree with all of it for the reviewers or the students. But I feel like I've just, I've had a trajectory of recognizing the value of like hearing other people. And so I build that in to every class it's like in [Introductory Qualitative 2] they run focus groups in class and they give each other feedback. Like part of them are participants and part of them are observers. And they give each other feedback. And so in this class, they do a lot of collaborative work. They have workshoped their manifestos with one another. They have we do tons of jam boards. I'm all about Google Jamboards because it's a really cool collaborative tool. But the data analysis, the goal there is to set up a situation where their interactions with one another are beneficial are collegial are meaningful are empowering. And it's really useful to because, I mean, they all, you don't go into a PhD program because you're not good at school, right? Like we all do school real good. And and teaching them that they have more to learn, that other people can help them to think differently. And so a number of them, so for the data analysis, I have some that are very like arts-based thinkers and I have some that are not, I am not. But like when they were working with other people, they would be like, well, yeah, but what if you did this or like, you could do this in Canva or like Padlet can make this really cool or whatever. And so there are a number of them that when they got to their manifesto, they're like, I want to play with this tool now because I've thought about like the way that it potentially like work in my research. And so that's one of the things that's a benefit of them working collaboratively is that it given them it gives them tools, it gives them perspectives, it gives them ideas that they're not going to get otherwise. And it's not, it's not competitive. Like there's no competition built-in. There's no grade related to that process. And that's that's the way that it often works like even for the folks, cuz they don't get a grade for the focus group. They get a grade for like pre focus group reflection, post focus group reflection. But the focus group itself, there's no grade. And so like creating situations where like the collaboration is the point and then giving them time to do that. Because a lot of times I think I know when I was doc student that there were a lot of times I was asked to collaborate with people, but it always had to happen outside of class. No that shit don't work. We have too much life and too my schedule. And so giving them time in class and then being there as a resource, it creates a better community, frankly. It creates a space where they feel able to credit one another. They feel able to like to defer to and depend on one another. It also creates a situation where like when the one guy like says stupid stuff, the rest of them know like he's not, he's not being there isn't, there's nothing malicious about it. He's just ignorant. And so because they've interacted with one another and they know him in different contexts, they're able to immediately know, we just need to correct you. And then we move on. And then similarly, he's able to respond to that in a positive way. He doesn't feel defensive or angry because he knows them like he's interacting with and he shared his work with them, they've supported him. And it also I think it also is cool because it helps them, we have all sat in classes, were raised like when we look at a person, um, or like how did you get into this program? Like how are you here? Like we all know the feeling, right? And I think it's really useful for them to see each other scholars to recognize that they all have interests,

they all have abilities. There's one student in the class, she is super ditzy. But when it comes to like her wheelhouse, she's a freaking genius. And it's been useful to have other students see her in that mode because otherwise they wouldn't. And so like her sharing her data and like talking through that and so on was useful for it was educative because it helped them to see her as appear rather than just some airhead who takes up space.

Interviewer: So one of the things we weren't able to hear very well with the conversations that they were having in the small groups.

[SITE A INSTRUCTOR]: Yes

Interviewer: And I just wondered if there's a way to capture the contours of those interactions that they were having around their data. Like what were some things that they often printed two or passion for her, it was like, how did they unfold, the interactions and fold?

Site A Instructor: I think one of the really cool things is that some of them actually changed or data from one week to the next. Because they, a lot of them, they were able to bring whatever data source they wanted. It was up to them. Some of them are in dissertation modes. They're like I'm bringing that to get some to get some ideas, but other ones were like, I don't know nothing yet. I will bring this thing from [Introductory Qualitative 1], which is also fine, right? I mean, they're guaranteed to have data because they will have done interviews, focus groups, ethnography, et cetera, like over the course of [Introductory Qualitative 1], [Introductory Qualitative 2] that sequence at minimum, right? And so a lot of them brought initially like course data and especially [Introductory Qualitative 1], like they don't know nothing, right? And so a lot of what they do is dumb. And so it was really useful for them to, in some cases, to look back on that. And so a lot of what I heard happening in some of the groups was like them reflecting on ways that they've grown as researchers. Which is really nice because I'd like, I've had people cry [Introductory Qualitative 1]. Not because I'm a scary mean person, but just because it's just I think it feels overwhelming. And there's all these like big multi-syllabic terms and you know, whatever. And for a lot of them it was really cool, I think, for them to recognize the degrees to which they had grown. And so like one of the to-like one of the conversations that came up in several groups was like this issue of voice. Like having this attitude in like [Introductory Qualitative 1] that like I'm giving voice to these participants. And now in [Advanced Qualitative 3] recognizing like that's colonizing as hell. Like I need to not, I need to not think that way. But being able to like self-critique. And I think also one of the other benefits of collaboration is that like other people were able to be there and be like I also did those dumb things and so then it doesn't feel like I failed personally. It's more of just like a, this is part of the learning process. You have all progressed in this way. And I will also say as a side note that some of the manifestos are actually like it's, it's an effort to try to recognize personal growth. And so like one person is actually creating what does she call it? It's like, it's basically going to be like a almost like a dictionary of qualitative terms that like she she started keeping them when she was an [Introductory Qualitative 1]. And she's like, I don't know these words. And now in [Advanced Qualitative 3], it's more of like going back and like redefining those terms like on her terms, right. And so the data analysis, I think, initiated some of that. Like just like beginning to recognize, I shouldn't do this. Like I, you know, I've, I've done this and now I know better. I would do this differently. One of the other things, so I mentioned like some of them brought different data after the first week. A number of them like once I realized, like because I think a lot of times there's something really vulnerable about sharing, sharing, writing and sharing data with other people. Because there's always this like or they don't think I'm an idiot, or they don't think that

I saw. And I think that, you know, one of the other benefits of collaboration is there's a shared vulnerability, right? Like nobody's having to put themselves out there and um I have shared my data with all of them and various other classes. In [Introductory Qualitative 1], they actually helped code, my data and some of it from when I was a doc student because I can be like look, I was also a moron. And I have moments when I am not, now. And, you know, and so with the sheer vulnerability, the first night, I think we only had time for one person, maybe two, I don't remember. But I think they all sort of realized like, we're acting in good faith with one another, right? Like we're all were actually supporting one another. We're actually going to give feedback and give ideas. And so a lot of them are like, can I change what I brought like can I change the data that I had initially intended to use? Because I realized this could actually be more useful if I approach this differently relative to the thing that I bring to share in this class and workshop. And so that was really cool to one student, god bless her, she, by virtue of the work that she's done in class, she realized like her, what she had planned for her dissertation isn't going to work. And, and some of that's happened in this class where she's gotten a lot of feedback from peers and, and for me to some to a lesser degree, I think I think her peers were in the majority this work we're just like recognizing that what she had intended to do it was like good intentioned but really problematic things. And so now trying to figure out like how do I renegotiate that with my chair so that it's legible in ways that they get for the field, but also something that honors the conversations that I've had here. And so, and so, and one of the other things too that I think was really nice, it's, it's a weird class, [Advanced Qualitative 3] is in that like the only prerequisite is [Introductory Qualitative 2]. So they literally could just have taken [Introductory Qualitative 1] [Introductory Qualitative 2] and a number of them, there's a there's a Fellows program here that's funded through [institute], I don't know, maybe I don't know something. But anyway, maybe it's the [government department], whatever it is, it's some big government entity, something. But so there's a Fellows program, they actually require the fellows to take the qualitative certificate. And the reason they do that is because it's a very quant heavy field. And the people that are, that, are, that, our vocabulary systems shutting down, the people who facilitate, who manage that program, realized, like they don't know anything about qualitative research. Some of the questions that they have relative to these facilities, some of the questions that they're fellows have, our qualitative questions, they're not quantitative. And so anyway, and so all that is to say that like, you know, they, they, they're in the class. I lost my train of thought. Where was I going? Oh, no.

Interviewer: They can only take some people only have three.

Site A Instructor: Yes. Yes. Thank you. And so some of them thank you, some of them are very advanced because they've, they've taken all the classes and a few of them are getting the PhD and so they're very advanced. They're all getting a certificate, in most cases, there is occasionally a few that are just like I'll take [Advanced Qualitative 3] for fun. But then there's also students like that's all they take [Introductory Qualitative 1] and [Introductory Qualitative 2]. And that's enough, it's enough to be dangerous. And so one of the other really nice things about the data analysis is that a lot of the students initially had this attitude of, I'm not really a researcher yet. I'm not doing my own research yet. Like I'm not, I'm not for real yet. And then seeing the students that were more advance and their trajectories as being real researchers and them being like, I only have class data right. But then like having them share and give feedback to one another. It was useful because a number of them were like, okay, so I haven't done my own data collection yet but I can get the tenets of research like I understood, I can think like a researcher, I can offer feedback to other people that have collected their own data and so it's like shifting this mindset one has to have collected all this data independently in order to be a researcher. And so that was like that was a really useful conversation that came

up a few times. Because at the beginning I have a policy where students are not allowed to apologize unless they actually like like step on somebody or something, right. But there's like this habit of like, you know, I'm so sorry, I have a question or this is probably dumb, but it's just like, nope. And so there were a lot of students at the beginning, like the other students, like monitor that behavior and they're just like you're apologizing about not being a researcher but you're in [Advanced Qualitative 3]. And so that was a really useful way that, that they, they supported one another and understood the data analysis as being, it was I'm not going to say it was identity shifting because I think that's a bit of an overstatement, but I think that it was useful in modifying and constructing identity differently relative to research.

Interviewer: Mm-hm, Mm-hm, Mm-hm. Yeah, that's really interesting. [Speaker 3] do you want to ask any questions?

Site A Instructor: Hit me, I'm ready.

[Speaker 3]: I like had some and then engaged again and then had some and engaged again. I

Site A Instructor: Well, I'm not wording real good today though. I can't think of them now, honestly. I had one or two, but they have left the building of my brain.

Site A Instructor: I mean, you saw earlier like words left my building.

[Speaker 3]: If I think I can think of anything before we end I'll just
Site A Instructor: You can also just e-mail me. [Interviewer] can attest I'm I'm very good about responding to email.

Interviewer: She's yeah this is like quickness at its best.

[Speaker 3]: I either do it right away or three days.

Site A Instructor: I think that's normal.

Interviewer: Well, so [Site A Instructor], my last question is, is there anything else you'd like to share about your experience with data analysis in this particular context?

Site A Instructor: well, I mean, first of all, I wish, I wish there had been a better way to collect the data. It's funny because as the semester went on and like flu started to break out and so on like now we're more hybrid, data collection would actually be really easy now, because the majority of them are in breakout groups. That would've been super simple. But the data analysis thing I've done, I've done things like this in the past, but I've never done it relative to this idea of like trying to, to, to question structural new norms. And I think it's a really useful way to, I think I'm definitely going to incorporate it into the social justice class that I teach next semester. I don't know about case study. Case study is always a mixed bag because there is no prerequisite for case study. Because it is the school and the humans, the, what is [health education unit] like they require it.

Interviewer: This is their first qual class?

Site A Instructor: in some cases this is their only qual class which is alarming. And so I end up with similarly like there were students that are in there because they're getting the co-op easier to call shift again are taking it as whatever electives. There's also students are like I am

here because I must be like I'm here because I'm going to do case study. I'd like you to note it is yet, but let's see. So I don't I don't know like for call one and case study. I don't know. I don't know about this idea of like this this notion of refusal relative to data analysis yet, because I don't, I don't know that they know enough to refuse anything yet. But I think definitely for [Introductory Qualitative 2] there's, there's definitely going to be a data analytic component and [Introductory Qualitative 2] that is different from what it's been in the past. They, they run focus groups and they collect ethnographic fieldnotes. And then they, they produce ethnographic narratives. And I think that I think that incorporating some of, some of this idea of process over product could be really useful, especially for the focus groups. I feel like I kinda do that with the narratives already because like there's a lot of like pure writer workshoping of the narratives. But I think that there are ways to do that differently because that's, that's data production that could be re-imagined and then the idea of like, okay, now we have these narratives like what does one do with them, right? Like what, what, what now we have produced these things. Because I feel like that's a lot of times like that's the missing step for not just doc students, but like qualitative researchers in general, is like there's this, there's this near desperation to produce data. But then like what is, what does one do with it that is meaningful and useful? That is methodological and not just method. And so I think that I think that, that this this data analysis foray that they have helped me to experiment and I was really frank with them at the beginning of the semester. I'm, I'm like, We gonna see. I think that in the future for [Advanced Qualitative 3], I'm going to be much more explicit about there's not a product, there's a process. And you know, and if students are really adamant in the course observations, Jesus Christ, my, like my words, in my course observations you know that there needed to be something or they need to be an assignment or whatever, I think, I think it might, it might be some sort of reflection paper or some sorta, or even potentially like a group reflection paper. Cuz that's that, I've done that before too, like group papers, those are always fascinating. But like something that again like takes it away from, like the adamant insistence on must produce data, must crunch data kind of thing. So I think that, that, that's definitely a shift that will happen in [Advanced Qualitative 3], but I do think that there are ways to incorporate this much more explicit engagement with data analysis differently, especially in [Introductory Qualitative 2]. Because by then they're not crying anymore. They're there, they're ready. And I'm definitely going, there's definitely gonna be more of this in the interviewing class that I teach because they do a good number of interviews. And so they end up with a substantial amount of data and so thinking about being really intentional about data production and then really intentional about data analysis, like okay, now you have this thing, what will you do with it? And how does what you're doing with it align with who you claim to be theoretically who you claim to be methodologically? 'Cuz I think that was one of the conversations that that did come up in the groups a whole lot was like this recognition of like, you know, I I subscribe heavily to like black feminist thought but then I'm so busy, you know, interjecting into the interview that like, I'm not listening to these women. And so like I think there's something really useful in like self, self analysis of data analysis so that you're able to recognize incongruencies in intent versus effect. And then the ways that that potentially plays out and shapes the research process and the research product. And the then any analysis of the product and then the representation of of said analysis, right, and so, I don't know, and I, I do, I think I'm not an arts-based thinker at all, I don't, I don't think that way, I work really well with people who do think that way. And I appreciate that way of thinking, but it's not a mode of thought for me. And I think that if I had potentially been pushed to, to, to have to engage with alternative ways to analyze alternative ways to communicate my findings, I don't know, I mean, I would at least be able to say I choose not to do that rather than I don't think that way. And so I, and so anyway, and so those are all those are all meandering thoughts, but I mean, what has happened this semester overall has been very productive. It's been it's been it's been a really good class overall, I think for them and for

me, and if they're, if they're writing and their responses to assignments are indicative, I think that like they thought a lot, but they've also, they've thought about themselves. They've thought about themselves relative to the field. And so that's probably the last thing that I'll say is that they, I think a lot of them came into this class thinking of themselves as like, I am a student of qualitative research. And I think that the majority of them, I'm not going to say all of them just because like I hesitate to say that, but I mean potentially all of them, I think a lot of them at least are leaving the class with more of a mentality of like, I am a qualitative researcher. I'm not like I'm here to learn, teach me. But instead like I engage with this, I can do this work. And so shifting that like I'm not a real researcher into I am a researcher and when it's time for me to start doing the research that I envision being important. I feel well-equipped to do that.

Interviewer: Mm, mm,

Site A Instructor: which is bad ass.

Interviewer: Yeah, it is. Yeah, that's really powerful. Well, we have really enjoyed learning from you and we're still going through the the classroom data that you sent.

Site A Instructor: I can't imagine.

Interviewer: And also conducting from additional student interviews as well.

Site A Instructor: Great.

Interviewer: Just to give you a sense of our timeline is we'll be collecting data at a different institutional site in the spring. And so we anticipate reaching back out to you to share some initial thoughts or late spring, early summer. And then of course, as we progress, if you're okay with it and if questions come up for us, that would reach out to you via email to gain clarification.

Site A Instructor: Yeah that's totally cool. No, I think this is I mean, I think it's a really important project um and it has been my honor to contribute, participate, um, I never know exactly what the effect of our participation in something is. Hopefully it will be useful. But I'm super glad that you're going to talk to some of the students. They are brilliant, amazing, wonderful humans. So enjoy that because I have.

Interviewer: Yeah. we've already experienced that. So its been really generative. Yeah, so thank you so much, Participant, I know this added another layer of logistics on an already interesting time to be teaching courses.

Site A Instructor: it is what it is.

Interviewer: Yeah, but it's been really generative and it's just for us as the group [colleague] [Speaker 3], and myself, it's also led us to ask lots of interesting questions that aren't necessarily a part of this project with the [research partner] folks, just thinking about data analysis, even just thinking about what you just said around thinking through [Introductory Qualitative 1] versus [Advanced Qualitative 3], that was something that we were all thinking through as we watched the the classroom data of when do you introduce these ideas to people?

Site A Instructor: Yeah. It's a tricky balancing act sometimes, for sure. Yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah. So it's been it's been awesome and it will just continue to be because now you live with us on our computers.

Site A Instructor: Actually. I mean, that's that's one of the nice things I would say about like all the pandemic nonsense. I do feel able to connect more easily with people who are not in [this state]?

Interviewer: Oh, yeah.